

McAfee “accidentally” fixes bug

When McAfee updated their ePolicy Orchestrator to version 3.5.5, they fixed a critical security flaw that could have had horrifying results. Without planning for it. And they admitted it, too.



Immortalise Yourself in Firefox's code

World Firefox Day is on September 15th, and if you manage to convince a friend to adopt the browser before then, your name might feature in the Fox's source code. Start spamming your friends now!



Escape

WHEN LIGHTNING STRIKES

iSaveLives

As if we didn't have enough iPod fanboyism to deal with, it turns out that the unassuming pod in question can prove to be an essential survival tool as well. This time, it's responsible for saving the life of young Jason Bunch, a resident of Colorado, USA. Seventeen-year-old Bunch was zapped by the heavens early July as he walked about his hometown listening to Metallica. He did note the necessity to take shelter as the storm approached, but it seems that the clouds were too fast for him. His next memory was waking up in bed with bleeding ears and nausea. He was rushed to the hospital soon enough.

Bunch's burns traced the wire running from his ears to his iPod, which was fastened to the hip. Apparently, the wire saved his life, directing the bulk of

the electric current away from his vitals. The 'pod, in a remarkable act of loyalty and general unawareness, sacrificed its life to save its master's, ending up with a hole bored straight through.

It seems to us that lightning, moving away from such boring targets as trees and buildings has turned to something more entertaining this year—young, tech-enabled kids. Young Bunch isn't the first teen to face off with these glorified sparks in the past few months—not too long ago, a 19-year old Mumbai girl suffered death by lightning, attributed to the fact that she was carrying all her friends' cell phones. Another case surfaced soon—London, this time—of a cell-toting 15-year old girl, though she lived to tell the tale.

Moral of the story (choose one):

1. Music players can save your life (try at own risk)
2. When it rains, stay indoors

CELLULITE WAR

Military Tech To Fight New Enemy

The battle to look good is a long, painful one. Ask any woman. Well, to be politically correct, ask *anyone*. We all despise our ungainly flab and will do anything to get rid of it. It was only a matter of time, then, that cosmetic companies would turn to new weapons—weapons of war even—to even the ground.

Israeli company Syneron Medical, long involved in the manufacture of machines for aesthetic medical procedures—vein removal

Whatever Happened To...

CAS

During mid-2003, there was big talk of CAS (Conditional Access System) to be implemented in the metros and select cities. Had CAS been fully implemented, we would today be having set-top boxes to view pay channels—and many non-regional channels today are paid-for. The set-top box cost upwards of Rs 3,000. Pay channels could be unscrambled only with the help of a smart card inserted into the box. This meant every viewer who subscribed to a pay channel would be accounted for, and the Government as well as the channel would be guaranteed of income from each subscriber.

In principle this seems fair—you pay for what you watch, and the Government doesn't lose out on tax—this besides bringing in transparency to the cable TV business. So why didn't CAS take off?

First off, the initial cost of the set-top box. Then, the higher, recurring cost of subscription. In theory the subscriber has the choice of choosing the channels he wants, but more often than not, one had to buy a package of channels. Cable operators would be able to charge only for the infrastructure and not for the channels. Despite the Government's push towards CAS, these and other factors prevented this good-on-paper concept from seeing the light.

Win! My Desktop

Haider's spaced out desktop comes from interesting use of ObjectDock and DesktopX widgets. He used:

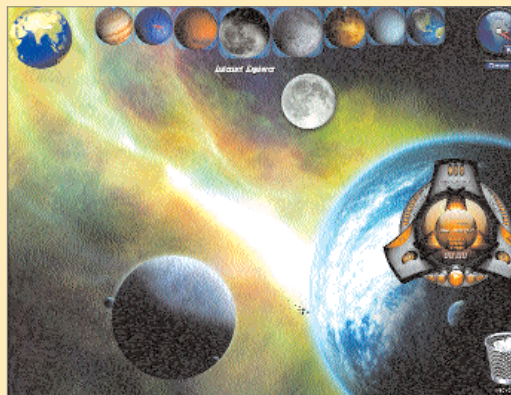
The Moon Widget
The Global Clock Widget
The Planet Icon Pack
ObjectDock to hide the Start Menu, and
A Registry hack to remove the Recycle Bin from the desktop.
Congratulations!

Participate in this contest and win next month

**Microsoft 2003 Bible
All-IP Networks**

by Edward C. Willett

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Send your desktop with description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject 'My Desktop'; and tell us your postal address, too.